Paragraph Patterns



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Types of Paragraph Patterns

- Exemplification
- Narration
- Description
- Process Analysis
- Cause and Effect
- Comparison and Contrast
- Definition
- Classification
- Argument/Persuasion

Exemplification

- To explain statements that we make with examples, details or specific instances.

Example:

The new shirt I bought is poorly made. When I washed it, the colors began to fade, one button cracked and another fell off, a shoulder seam opened, and the sleeves shrank almost two inches.

Narration

- We just tell a story in a chronological order with some details.

Example for Narration

I was hurrying across campus to get to a class. It had rained heavily all morning, so I was hopscotching my way around puddles in the pathway. I called to two friends ahead to wait for me, and right before I caught up to them, I came to a large puddle that covered the entire path. I had to make a quick choice of either stepping into the puddle or trying to jump over it. I jumped, wanting to seem cool, since my friends were watching, but didn't clear the puddle. Water splashed everywhere, drenching my shoe, sock, and pants cuff, and spraying the pants of my friends as well. "Well done, Dave!" they said. My embarrassment was all the greater because I had tried to look so casual.

Description

- It describes something or someone with vivid words, appealing to a reader's sight, hearing, taste, smell or tough.

Example:

A rug covers the living-room floor. (Not vivid)

A thick, reddish-brown shag rug is laid wall to wall across the living-room floor. The long, curled fibers of the shag seem to whisper as you walk through them in your bare feet, and when you squeeze your toes into the deep covering, the soft fibers push back at you with a spongy resilience.

Process

- It explains the reader how to do or make certain things in the sequence of steps

Example: How to cook a perfect steak

To begin, pat the steak dry with paper towels. Season the steaks generously on both sides with salt and pepper; the seasoning will stick to the surface and help create a delicious crust....



Cause and Effect

- A writer literarily does some detective work by examining the causes of something or the effects of something.

Example:

He lost his life for no particular good cause; only made a couple of selfie for his followers on instagram on the edge of a cliff and slipped into the abyss. Among his followers were some who saw the last moments of all the horrors he expressed in his face and conveyed through his empty eyes. Instagram removed that footage from his account. Rest in peace!

Comparison and contrast

- We compare two things to show how they are similar and contrast for their difference.

Example: Energy drinks

Just as driving recklessly may lead to a fatal crash, so does consuming energy drinks if ignoring a recommended daily norm.

Definition

- It offers informal definitions to explain what a particular term means.

Example: What is death?
What does Aristotle say about death?
According to Aristotle, the dead are more blessed and happier than the living, and to die is to return to one's real home.

Classification

- This pattern separates many things into categories so that we could manage or understand them better.

Example: Date Classification

Data Classification in Government organizations commonly includes five levels: Top Secret, Secret, Confidential, Sensitive, and Unclassified. These can be adopted by commercial organizations, but, most often, we find four levels, Restricted, Confidential, Internal, Public. These four are far more straightforward, and their names align to how they should be handled.

Argument

- It makes a challenging point and defend it with a series of solid points.

What is an argument? In academic writing, an argument is usually a main idea, often called a "claim" or "thesis statement," backed up with evidence that supports the idea.

Reference

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